

KIMBERLY (KIM) BELL

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SENIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER IN TEST (SDET)

Automation Architecture | CI/CD | Scalable Test Strategy

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

With 8+ years of software experience, I bring a developer's mindset to quality engineering, architecting automation frameworks that teams adopt, and building cross-team collaboration that bridges QA and engineering. I practice shift-left testing by design, embedding test planning early in Agile sprints, integrating test gates into CI/CD pipelines, and covering responsive behavior in automation so quality is built in from the start. Currently working in Playwright while actively seeking Senior SDET or QA Engineer roles.

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: JavaScript, Typescript, React

Testing: Cypress, Playwright, Jest, Testing Library, E2E, Integration, Regression, API, Accessibility, Responsive, SQL (working knowledge)

CI/CD & Tools: Git, Gitlab CI/CD, Github Actions, Bitbucket, BrowserStack, LogRocket, Jira, Confluence, qTest

CONTINUOUS LEARNING & PROJECTS

Independent Study & Projects

Dec 2025 - current

playwright-test-collection - github.com/TzolkinB/playwright-test-collection

Converted an existing Cypress test suite to Playwright, demonstrating hands-on framework migration. Covers UI integration tests and REST API tests, with shared fixtures and helper abstractions to eliminate duplication across spec files.

loop-playwright - github.com/TzolkinB/loop-playwright

Data-driven Playwright test suite using Page Object Model (POM), JSON test data, and Typescript enums for type-safe parameterization. Covers web and mobile views, login/auth setup, and is architected for scalability - new test scenarios are added via data files with no test-code changes required.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Sabbatical - Medical leave; now available for full-time roles.

Jan 2024 - Nov 2025

Ally Financial, Charlotte, NC

Senior SDET - Remote

Jan 2022 - Dec 2023

*Built Ally's automation infrastructure that enabled **10 teams** to shift from manual to automated testing. As the technical lead and primary escalation point for framework issues, I partnered with product and engineering teams to align workflows and eliminate bottlenecks. Scaled automation framework to 35 repositories, establishing a standard across multiple business lines*

- Led transition from **100% manual** → **90% automated testing** across 10 teams in **2 years** using Cypress, TypeScript, and CI/CD, **reducing regression effort and enabling consistent 2-week release cycles**
- Architected a TypeScript-based Cypress framework (internal NPM package) adopted across **35 repositories (from 11)**, standardizing test strategy across **multiple business lines**
- Integrated UI automation into CI/CD pipelines, **reducing release hardening time from hours to minutes** and ensuring **on-schedule sprint deployments**

- Built and scaled reusable Cypress commands and testing standards, **accelerating test development by 75%** and enabling consistent execution across teams
- Reduced test flakiness across 10 teams by implementing mocking strategies for environmental dependencies — feature flags, API contract changes — and establishing common test patterns with built-in guards for test stability

Software Engineer

Dec 2018 - Dec 2021

*Joined during Ally's critical Ember-to-React migration, developing features across **2+ ecosystems** while simultaneously leading the parallel effort to migrate and modernize automated tests. Became the subject matter expert on Cypress, training teams and accelerating tool adoption across the organization.*

- Delivered frontend features across **Ember and React ecosystems** during a large-scale migration, balancing feature delivery with modernization efforts
- Championed Cypress adoption by leading training and establishing foundational testing patterns that became the **standard across the organization**
- Led migration of automated tests to align with React architecture, **maintaining test coverage and stability during platform transition**

REASON CONSULTING CORPORATION (previously Tax Management Associates), Charlotte, NC

Software Engineer

Jan 2018 - Nov 2018

Accelerated UI/UX development processes, providing technical training and building React applications that bridged design concepts with production-ready code.

- Trained UI/UX designers in React, improving design-to-development workflow and **reducing iteration friction**
- Built **2 production React applications**, translating requirements into scalable, user-facing solutions

Junior Frontend Developer / Apprentice

Oct 2015 - Dec 2017

- Contributed to frontend development using JavaScript and React, supporting delivery of user-facing applications in an Agile environment

EDUCATION

Master of Arts (MA) , International Human Rights, University of Denver, Denver, CO	2011
Bachelor of Arts (BA) , Anthropology, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC	2008